

Citadel Journal Issue 3

CURSÉD OF NAGGAROTH

Dark Elf Beastmasters and Power Stones



MAN O' WAR

Curséd of Naggaroth.

By Gavin Thorpe.

The frenzied and monstrous fleets of the Dark Elves constantly sally forth to raid Ulthuan and wreak havoc on the vessels of other races. This article expands the options available to a Dark Elf



Since the civil war that raged in Ulthuan 7,000 years ago, the Dark Elves have been a constant threat to the peace of all nations. Their horrific rites and festivals have been performed in all the countries of the Old World, their Huge Black Arks carrying them across the unforgiving seas so that they may plunder and murder with malicious abandon. The shores of Ulthuan itself are constantly ravaged by their raids, and the fleets of other races only venture near the Bleak Coast when it would be certain death to stay further away. The monsters of the deep are at the beck and call of the twisted Beast-Lords, who are powerful Mages specialising in the binding and controlling of wild monsters and daemons. The Beast-Lords sing harsh enchantments over the waves, calling more of the dreaded creatures that have plagued the legends of races for millennia. The Kraken, Megalodon, and Sea Dragon have all destroyed ships, while on convoy from distant Cathay, or just port-hopping along the coasts of Bretonnia and Estalia.

The horrifying power of the Beast-Lords was demonstrated three centuries ago, when a Black Ark and its fleet were sighted from the Dwarfen Sea-Fortress of Barak-Varr. The Dwarfs promptly assembled their fleet and sailed forth to destroy them, as was their duty. The descendants of the

Ancestor-Gods confronted the Dark Elf fleet, which was small compared to their own, and their Runes and Engineers proved worthy to the task. However, the Dark Elves had laid a trap; as the Dwarfs closed for the kill the Beast-Lords shrilled their keening cries across the tumultuous waves. From the depths rose scores of mighty beasts, including the dreaded Gargantuan, the swift and deadly Black Leviathan, and the ship devouring Promethean. The Dwarfs cried in horror and tore at their beards when they realised their peril. The monsters rent the proud Dwarfen Dreadnoughts and Ironclads, Monitors were torn apart by the writhing coils of Sea Dragons, while the Dark Elf Sorcerers on the Black Ark bombarded the fleet with magical annihilation. Only a few Dwarfs survived that dreadful defeat, and most of those that did immediately took the Slayer Oath.

The Tainted Stones.

In ancient times, before the sundering of the Elven race, two mighty Wizards created artefacts of great power for the Elven captains and Admirals. These were known as the Crystals of Power, and many survive to this day. However, during the civil war some of these crystals fell into the hands of the Dark Elves, through deceit, theft or betrayal. The original subtle and non-aggressive abilities of these items have been malevolently warped over the centuries, so that they suit the needs of the Dark Elves better. Some have been seized by the Beast-Lords and aid them during their summoning and spell-weaving, while others are used by Captains to enhance their ships.

Witch Elves.

The Witch Elves of Naggaroth are the priestesses of Khaine, the God of Murder, the rites and sacrifices that these she-devils dedicate to their master are horrific. In battle they receive the blessing of Khaine and turn into vicious killing machines, leaping, slashing, tearing and biting their way through the opposing warriors.

GAME RULES.

Beast-Lords.

The magical prowess of the Dark Elf Beast-Lords is directed towards summoning and controlling daemons and monsters. In Man O' War this means they have certain powers over the Dark Elf Monsters and other Sea Monsters. You may buy a Beast-Lord for each Death Fortress and Black Ark in your fleet. Place the Beast-Lord counter on the ship's template, just like an Admiral or Wizard, and follow all of the rules for them regarding Clinging to Wreckage, capture and death. They are worth 2 Battle Honours. Certain Tainted Stones can be bought for Beast-lords.

A Beast-Lord May attempt to summon monsters during the game. The presence of a Beast-Lord in your fleet allows you to add +1 to any summoning rolls you make. This is not cumulative with the casting bonus of a Wizard Lord, you will only ever have a maximum of +1 to your roll, irrespective of the source. During each Magic Phase, after spells have been cast, your Beast-Lords may attempt to call another Sea Monster. Roll a number of D6's equal to the number of Beast-Lords in your fleet, if any of them score a 6 you may place a Sea Monster Summoning template on the seascape.

This template must be selected at random. Shuffle the Summoning Templates you have available face down, select one and place it within 12" of one of your Beast-Lords. Only now may you look at the Template to see what it is.

If the Template indicates that it is Triton your opponent will gain him as part of his forces, if he has one of the Fleets that is allowed to buy Triton. If he has Skaven, Chaos or Orcs then the calling is wasted and Triton's Template should be set aside. The template follows all of the normal rules for the rest of the game. You may only call one monster per turn, no matter how many 6's you roll. You may not attempt to summon a Sea Monster on the same turn that it was called.

Tainted Stones

The pages after this article contain some Tainted Stones cards. These can be bought for either your Black Ark or your Beast-Lords, as detailed on the cards. Each Beast-Lord and Black Ark may only be given a single Stone.

Each card details all of the effects the Stone has on the game, its cost and also the number of Battle Honours it is worth. The Battle Honours value is added to those awarded to the opponent when the Black Ark is sunk or the Beast-Lord is killed or captured.

There is only one of each Stone so you may not have more than one of each in a game. Each Beast-Lord or Black Ark may only be given one Stone, though if you have a Beast-Lord on your Black Ark you could buy one for the Ark itself and another one for the Beast-Lord. If you are battling against another Dark Elf fleet you should agree with your opponent on some system which decides who can have what Stones. Here are a couple of ideas:

You can shuffle the deck and deal them evenly between the Dark Elf players. You may only purchase from the Stones you have been dealt.

You could choose your Stones freely, and if your opponent has the same Stone roll a D6 each with the highest scoring player keeping the Stone, while the loser must spend the points on something else (not another Stone).

You could just agree not to use the Stones at all.

Witch Elves.

You may purchase a coven of Witch Elves for your Admiral's Black Ark. Place the Witch Elf token on the ship's template. The Witch Elves do not count towards the Crew capacity of the Ark, but do give a +1 bonus in boarding actions. In addition, when the Black Ark attacks another vessel by boarding the Witch Elves may drag off sacrificial victims if the Dark Elves win. To represent this when an enemy ship loses a boarding action while defending against the Black Ark, roll a D6. On a roll of 5 or 6 the Witch Elves manage to ensnare some of the enemy crew, remove two crew counters instead of one. Witch Elves are ferocious fighters and cannot be killed by ranged attacks or boarding. Only if all the other crew counters are destroyed should you remove the Witch Elf counter from the template. If the Witch Elves are destroyed your opponent gains

1 Battle Honour for the ship who killed the last remaining crew counter.

TRITON

Triton loathes the evil races of the world, such as Orcs, Chaos and Skaven, but this is due to their nature, and the effect they have on the world in general. For Dark Elves he reserves his deepest hatred, as they have captured and twisted his beloved creatures of the deep. There is no limit to his anger when he encounters the hideous Beast-Lords, he attempts to thwart their designs at every turn. The enmity is not one way either, the Beast-Lords long to destroy Triton and ensure their dominion over the seas and oceans is uncontested.

Special Rules.

When Triton is fighting against a Dark Elf fleet that contains one or more Beast-Lords he tries to turn their creatures against them. When you roll to see if Triton 'banishes' a Sea Monster he will banish it as normal on a roll of 5. If he rolls a 6 the player who is controlling Triton may control the affected Sea Monster if it has not yet been used this turn. There is also a +2 modifier to Triton's reaction roll, instead of the usual +1 for fighting against Dark Elves.

If the Dark Elf player is using one or more Tainted Stones Triton can use some of the extra magical energy to cast another spell. At the start of the game Triton draws two spell cards instead of one, and one of these may be exchanged as normal. He may only cast one spell in a single turn, but all of the other rules for Triton's spells apply.

Dark Elf Fleet List

0+ Beast-Lords

You may purchase a Beast-Lord for each Black Ark and Death Fortress in your fleet.

Cost: 75 points each.

Worth 2 Battle Honours

0+ Tainted Stones

You may buy up to one Tainted Stone for each Black Ark and Beast-Lord in your fleet. No more than one of each Tainted Stone may be used in a battle.

Cost: As on cards.

0- 1 Witch Elf Coven

You may purchase a Witch Elf Coven for your Admiral's Black Ark.

Cost: 50 points.

Worth 1 Battle Honour

BEAST-LORD	BEAST-LORD	BEAST-LORD	BEAST-LORD
WITCH ELVES	BEAST-LORD	BEAST-LORD	BEAST-LORD

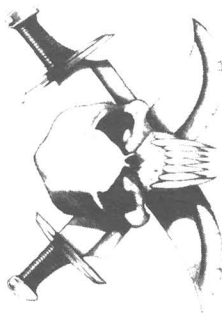
+2 BATTLE HONOURS 75 POINTS

Ikonarashk

Ikonarashk is the name given by the Dark Elves to this deep purple coloured Stone. When the correct chants are spoken over Ikonarashk it allows a Beast-Lord to communicate with the mind of a Sea Monster.

Effects: Ikonarashk allows a Beast-Lord to take control of a Dark Elf Sea Monster that has had its crew destroyed. The Sea Monster does not dive to the bottom as normal but may continue to move and fight as if it had a crew. If the Beast-Lord controlling the Monster is killed or captured it is removed from play as normal. Ikonarashk may only control one monster at a time. Further attacks on the vessels crew have no effect. The Monster may be re-crewed as normal, but discard the extra crew, do not place them on the template.

BEAST-LORD ONLY



TAINTED

STONE

+1 BATTLE HONOURS 50 POINTS

The Wild Mind

When a Sea Monster is not performing as its controlling Beast-Lord wishes he speaks words of power and magical lightning strikes out from the Wild Mind allowing the Beast-Lord to control his charges with more skill.

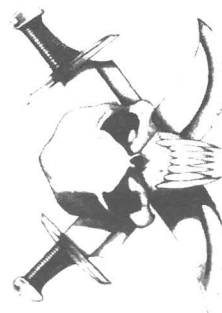
The Wildmind may be used only once per turn. It allows the dark Elf player to perform one of the following:

He can allow the Dark Elf player to re-roll the dice on the Doomsweaver Frenzy table, or

He may add one to a single Monster Reaction roll (i.e a double 1 counts as a double 2), or

He may prevent Triton using his 'Banish' ability on a roll of 4+ on a D6 (rolling to see if you are successful counts as the action for that turn).

BEAST-LORD ONLY



TAINTED

STONE

+2 BATTLE HONOUR 75 POINTS

The True-Seeker

The True-Seeker Stone was originally a device used by High Elf Captains to glance into the future. It is now a large black stone that sits upon a bronze cradle in the middle of the deck and draws all the available light into itself. Yet, despite the gloom it creates, it also helps to guide the Reapers that are mounted on the vessel. Each bolt thrower is bathed in an aura of darkness and they move and fire with unparalleled speed.

A Black Ark with the True-Seeker on board may add one to its dice rolls when it fires its Reapers or Sky-Reapers. Note that in the case of Reapers a roll of one still indicates that it is jammed.

BLACK ARK ONLY.



TAINTED

STONE

+2 BATTLE HONOURS 100 POINTS

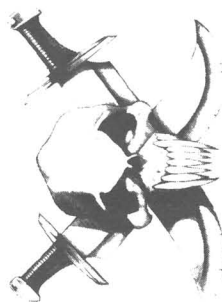
Irshkileth

Irshkileth is a deep red colour, and pulses to life when blood is spilled upon it. When the life force of a sacrificial victim is poured into its sponge-like surface it begins to emit a purring noise.

The Stone may be used to heal wounds on all Sea Monsters, not just those enslaved to the Dark Elves. The monster to be healed must be in contact with the ship Irshkileth is on, it immediately regains one wound. This may be used to heal Manticores Lords if they are in contact. You may only use this ability three times in a battle.

In addition, when on a Black Ark, Irshkileth allows the Dark Elf player to add +1 to his dice roll when he attempts to heal a monster that is within the Black Ark. This applies to one healing roll per turn. Irshkileth cannot perform both these abilities in the same turn.

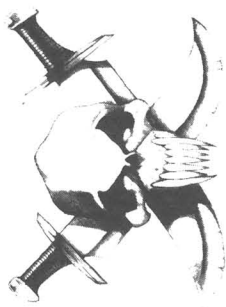
BLACK ARK ONLY



TAINTED

STONE

TAINTED



STONE

+1 BATTLE HONOURS 50 POINTS

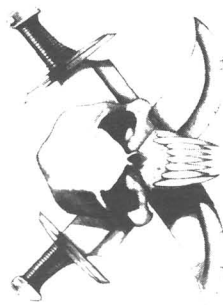
Misharolth

The Misharolth was kept for centuries in the deepest dungeons of a Black Ark, where the evil of the vessel slowly corrupted and changed this sickly green egg-shaped Stone. It is now eternally intertwined with the vessels of the Dark Elves. When the vessel takes damage the Misharolth emits an ear-piercing shriek, as if it felt the pain of the blow. Since the Misharolth needs the ship it uses its mystical powers to ensure its survival.

The power of the Misharolth may be invoked once per game, with the following effect. The Misharolth repairs one location on the Black Ark automatically, even a below the wateline hit. This can be done at any time, and can even be used to repair a below the wateline hit that would sink the Black Ark.

BLACK ARK ONLY

TAINTED



STONE

+2 BATTLE HONOUR 75 POINTS

Urkaronfir

This Stone requires the constant chants of Dark Elf priests to maintain control over its evil sentence. When it does the bidding of the Dark Elves it viciously strikes out with its magical energy, but sometimes it demands sacrifices or it will destroy the ship it is on.

Every turn, just before you move the Black Ark, roll 1D6. On a roll of 4+ Urkaronfir performs as wished, it has a 3 dice attack, with a range of 9" and a -1 Saving throw modifier which can be directed in any direction from the Black Ark. On a roll of 2-3 Urkaronfir does nothing this turn. A roll of 1 means the Black Ark must sacrifice one crew member of suffer D3 hits on Low locations.

BLACK ARK ONLY.

